

STRAND EDUCATIONAL INTEL MEMO — CYCLE 019

Target: THE 1953 TRUST (Epstein pour-over, executed 8 Aug 2019, USVI). Classification: OPEN-SOURCE / EDUCATIONAL. Not legal advice. Uncharged allegations remain uncharged.

Cycle date: 2026-09-23 | Agents: Ontologist · Distiller · Synthesizer · Bloodhound(+subs) · Upgrader

Prior cycle: C018 closed G-01–G-73. This cycle adds only independently sourced increments.

DISCIPLINE

This memo maps publicly reported entities, dockets, and money paths around the 1953 Trust remainder. It does not instruct anyone how to conceal assets, interfere with investigations, or harm persons. Criminal-inquiry reporting is treated as press-grade unless a charging instrument exists. No charging instrument was located on 23 Sep 2026.

1. CALENDAR LOCK (UNCHANGED UNLESS NOTED)

- Ward v. Indyke, S.D.N.Y. 1:24-cv-01204-AS: final-approval hearing reset to **2 Dec 2026, 14:00 ET** after ECF 445/446 supplemental social-media notice. Last confirmed docket tops at ECF 446 in C018; C019 did not locate ECF 447+ on public indexes as of this pass.
- USVI probate ST-2019-PB-00080 (Hon. Simone M. VanHolten-Turnbull): **Twenty-Seventh Quarterly Accounting** (1 Apr–30 Jun 2026) still the latest on the C-Track public portal (filed 31 Jul 2026). **No 28th accounting** located. Kathleen Lindman letter remains 3 Sep 2026.
- Deckoff v. VIBIR (D.V.I., filed 7 Jul 2026): territorial answer still due **19 Oct 2026**. Case number still not extracted from PACER-grade source (G-66/G-72 carry).
- 1:25-mc-00031 (N.D.N.Y. Truist satellite): closed 7 Jan 2026 — no reopen signal.
- 1:26-cv-08047 (Jane Doe / “Amy” v. estate/executors, Marsh/AWK): complaint filed 15 Sep 2026; service/magistrate track still open.

2. NEW / DEEPENED NODES (C019)

2.1 NBC same-day confirmation of uncharged federal inquiry (press-grade)

On 23 Sep 2026 NBC News, citing a senior law-enforcement official, reported that federal authorities have opened an investigation into Darren Indyke and Richard Kahn and that witness interviews are ongoing. The Justice Department issued a non-comment: it does not confirm or deny investigations. Counsel Daniel Ruzumna stated the clients have not been subpoenaed, have not been asked to speak with prosecutors, and have not been told they are subjects or targets. Ruzumna added that prosecutors recently asked to speak with at least one person who “provided services” to Epstein. This is an independent confirmation layer beside the WSJ piece distilled in C009–C018. It does **not** convert the matter into a charged case. Scope, district assignment inside SDNY/DOJ, and the identity of the “provided services” witness remain gaps.

2.2 Simone K. Lechuk — dual-hat instrument (mediator + fund administrator)

Public filings and professional biography now lock three distinct hats on one person, which C018 only partially resolved:

- **Mediator** of Ward: confidential session 28 Oct 2025; Mediator’s Proposal 18 Dec 2025; parties accepted 19 Dec 2025 (ECF 416-2 / ECF 425 narrative).
- **Fund Administrator** of the proposed Ward class settlement, supervising JND Legal Administration’s four-week Facebook/Instagram Feed+Stories campaign modeled on Doe v. Bank of America, 25-cv-8520 (JSR) (ECF 444 letter, 17 Sep 2026).
- **Prior Epstein-adjacent claims administrator**: Judge Rakoff appointed Lechuk to administer both the Deutsche Bank \$75 million survivor fund and the JPMorgan \$290 million survivor QSF; professional site and EFTA-released correspondence show a Freika PLLC New York mail drop and the domain epsteinSSFJPM.com.

Trauma-informed certification (National Center for Equity & Agency) is biography-grade, not a court finding. Instrument that appointed her Ward Fund Administrator (order vs. private engagement letter) remains G-68.

2.3 Ward consideration ratchet (eligibility count)

The proposed class consideration is two-tier: approximately **\$35 million if 40 or more eligible class members** qualify, or **\$25 million if fewer than 40**. That ratchet is in Lechuk’s preliminary-approval declaration (ECF 416-2) and in contemporaneous press (CNN 21 Sep 2026). Until the 60-day supplemental notice window closes after the social-media campaign, the payable number — and therefore the drain on any later 1953 remainder — is not fixed. Opt-out clock from ECF

446 remains 3 business days plus 60 days from notice.

2.4 1:26-cv-08047 — CSAM notification class vs estate/executors

Complaint filed 15 Sep 2026 by Jane Doe and “Amy” (pseudonyms) through Marsh Law Firm PLLC (Jennifer Freeman, James R. Marsh, Margaret E. Mabie, Helene M. Weiss, Gianna N. Elliot) and AWK Survivor Advocate Attorneys (Hillary M. Nappi, Jean Martin). The pleading seeks class certification of persons depicted as minors in collections seized from Epstein-controlled properties/devices, civil remedies under 18 U.S.C. § 2255 and 15 U.S.C. § 6851, and a court-ordered identification/notification program. Defendants as pleaded include the estate co-executors. This is a separate remainder-delay vector from Ward; it does not automatically stay Ward. Magistrate identity and proof of service remain G-33/G-43/G-78.

2.5 Deckoff / LSJVI / VIBIR / CZM (island path, not corpus)

Title to Little St. James is publicly described as held by **LSJVI, LLC** (Delaware holding company associated with Stephen Deckoff / SD Investments / Black Diamond). Purchase 2023 at reported \$60 million; half of island sale proceeds were committed to the territorial settlement with the estate — that is a **completed sale path**, not current 1953 corpus. VIBIR refund suit seeks \$5,757,038 for TY 2021 after an IRS examination asserted Deckoff was not a bona fide USVI resident; answer due 19 Oct 2026. DPNR/CZM: only permit publicly identified is an 8,800 sq ft warehouse application (Dec 2025), still described as incomplete pending environmental assessment. Trespass civil docket field (Owen/Dalton, Gil Sancho brothers, Petersen/Hall and others) is LSJVI-plaintiff, Cattie counsel — adjacent publicity risk, not a trust instrument. Spokesperson denial of any Epstein relationship stands un rebutted in open source.

2.6 Oversight contemporaneous node (compilation, weak remainder link)

House Oversight voted 41–0 on 15 Sep 2026 to recommend contempt as to Leon Black for a missed 3 Sep deposition and unproduced NDAs. Black’s January 2023 \$62.5 million territorial resolution is historical and is **not** a 1953 Trust distribution. Logged only so the 15–23 Sep 2026 press field is not silently omitted. Do not collapse Black → 1953 remainder without a primary instrument.

3. ONTOLOGY — REMAINDER vs TERRITORIAL vs SATELLITE

Keep three buckets separate:

- **1953 corpus / remainder:** pour-over after all estate claims are finally resolved. Named intended gifts (Shuliak \$100M incl. annuity concept; Indyke \$50M; Kahn \$25M; Maxwell; Mark Epstein line; redacted Article III / sub-trusts; 41-beneficiary compilation lists) are **intended**, not paid. Counsel for executors (Weiner/Ruzumna) publicly state neither client has received 1953 funds and probate may take three-plus years.
- **Territorial / sale proceeds:** USVI \$105M cash structure + half of island-sale proceeds; 27th accounting gross ~\$107.645M with ≥\$27M quantified liabilities (C008). Victim compensation program historical ~\$121–125M + later individual settlements. These reduce the estate before remainder.
- **Satellite vehicles:** 2019 Trust (18 Jan) + 4 Feb amendment; Butterfly (2006 / 2013 / DB 2014–19); Caterpillar 2017 (Wallace/Groff); Maple Inc.; NES LLC; Nine East 71st; Hyperion Air; HBRK / Beller; Southern Country International; Valar; unnamed liquidating fund. Intersection with 1953 still gap-coded unless an accounting line or trust schedule is produced.

4. AGENT WEFT (NON-MIRRORING)

- Bloodhound: CourtListener + C-Track portal + same-day press (NBC/CNBC/CNN) + professional bio (PLUS) + complaint PDF 08047.
- Ontologist: split Lelchuk hats; split remainder vs island-sale vs VIBIR personal-tax; refuse Black collapse.
- Distiller: two-tier \$35M/\$25M ratchet; “provided services” witness phrase; Freika PLLC mail drop.
- Synthesizer: Ward delay + 08047 + uncharged inquiry + no 28th accounting = remainder still legally upstream of any 1953 distribution.
- Upgrader: gaps G-74–G-80 appended; calendar unchanged.

5. GAPS G-01–G-80 (NEW THIS CYCLE)

Carried: G-01 instrument text variants; G-31/G-71 inquiry scope; G-32 capacity effect of an inquiry on executor authority; G-33/G-49 magistrate IDs; G-37/G-43 08047 service; G-66/G-72 VIBIR case number; G-68 Lelchuk appointment instrument; G-69 social-media campaign start date; G-70 28th accounting; G-73 post-notice opt-out count.

- **G-74** Identity and role of the person who “provided services” to Epstein and was approached by federal prosecutors (NBC 23 Sep 2026). Press-grade only.

- **G-75** Freika PLLC — engagement vs employer vs mail-drop for Lelchuk QSFs; any current Ward-fund banking path.
- **G-76** Running eligible-claimant count against the 40-person Ward ratchet.
- **G-77** D.V.I. civil case number for Deckoff v. VIBIR (filed 7 Jul 2026).
- **G-78** 08047 proof of service, assigned district judge/magistrate, and any early motion practice after 15 Sep 2026.
- **G-79** Any primary document linking Leon Black 2026 contempt fight to 1953 remainder (none found; keep compilation).
- **G-80** CZM warehouse application number and environmental-assessment status after Dec 2025 filing.

6. NEGATIVE RESULTS (MATERIAL)

No 28th USVI quarterly accounting. No Ward final judgment. No indictment or information naming Indyke or Kahn. No evidence located that 1953 remainder has been distributed. No verified 1:26-cv-06142 (C012 recast stands). No public instrument showing Deckoff funded or sat inside the 1953 structure.

7. BACKUP / DEPLOY

Local: artifacts/intel/1953-trust/STRAND-1953-TRUST-INTEL-MEMO-C019-2026-09-23.pdf and artifacts/strand-swarm-v3/out/C019_BREADCRUMB.json. Drive folder 1wiXh3en7s8H7BKIXEWWr6pDIlxStx0xF is mount-synced for files under artifacts/. GitHub target: cantgetalonggta-png/strand-osint-mesh (intel path). Explicit Drive copy requested by standing order.

End of Cycle 019. Educational OSINT only.